

# Practice Paper 7 — Answer Scheme

## Paper 2 — Comprehension

### Sections B & C

#### Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

#### Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

**Q1. [2]** — Two details showing the separation happened quickly

**1 mark each** for any two of:

- The doors hissed shut “a heartbeat before I could reach them” (suggesting only a split-second was missed).
- Her mother’s face “slide past”, and her mouth was still “opening around a word” — she had not even finished speaking.
- Her mother’s hand was “still half-raised” — caught mid-gesture, frozen in the act.
- The tunnel “swallowed them” almost immediately.
- The carriage “lurched forward into the dark” with the narrator alone “very suddenly”.

**Q2. [2]** — “Almost believed it”

**1 mark** — The plan was practical and sensible: she had a phone, money, the hotel name, and a clear next step, so on the surface there was no reason for alarm.

**1 mark** — The phrase “almost believed it” reveals that, **underneath**, she was already **frightened** / **unconvinced by her own calm**; she was talking herself into bravery rather than truly feeling it.

**Q3. [2]** — Pressing the phone harder

**1 mark** — It shows her **desperation** / **refusal to accept** that the phone is dead; she is grasping for any hope, however irrational.

**1 mark** — The phrase “as if force might restore what neglect had drained” also shows **self-reproach**: she knows she is to blame for not charging it, which sharpens her panic with guilt.

**Q4. [2]** — “Looked back at me indifferently”

**1 mark** — **Unusual**: A phone is an inanimate object and cannot look or feel anything; **personification** / human qualities are being given to a device.

**1 mark** — **Effect:** The word “indifferently” makes the phone seem **coldly uncaring**, which mirrors how **alone** and **unsupported** the narrator feels — even her own object will not help her.

**Q5. [2]** — Panic as a living thing

**1 mark** — The panic is **personified**: it is given the human actions of “stood up” and “began to walk around”, as if it were a separate person inside her chest.

**1 mark** — The progression from “waiting patiently” to active movement suggests that the panic is **no longer controllable** — it has **taken on a life of its own**, which makes her fear feel vivid and physical.

**Q6. [1]** — Evidence the narrator feels small

**1 mark** — Any **one** of:

- “The station felt suddenly enormous, and I felt suddenly very small.”
- People “hurried past me in both directions... none of them looking at me.”
- She could not remember the name of the hotel / the scrap of paper had been left behind.

**Q7. [2]** — Short, repeated sentence structure

(a) [1]: The two short, parallel sentences mirror the **broken, halting** way she is breathing or thinking; her mind is operating in small, controlled fragments because she is **barely holding herself together**.

(b) [1]: By understating the crying — describing only the **effort not to** — the writer makes the moment feel **more dignified** and **more moving**; it also shows the narrator is trying to retain control and self-respect in public.

**Q8. [2]** — “Drink. Then we think.”

**1 mark** — The short, almost commanding sentences suggest the woman is **calm, practical** and **decisive** — she does not waste words.

**1 mark** — They also suggest **kindness expressed through action**: she puts the immediate physical need (warmth, a drink) before discussion, which shows experience in dealing with distressed people.

**Q9. [2]** — “As if a blue elephant were the most ordinary landmark”

**1 mark** — The comparison suggests the woman is **unsurprised** / **unflappable**; she accepts the narrator’s odd, incomplete description without judgement.

**1 mark** — It also suggests **quiet reassurance**: by treating the strange detail as ordinary, she makes the narrator feel **less foolish** and **less panicked**.

**Q10. [2]** — Impression of the father

**1 mark** — He is normally **composed** and **dignified** — “my father does not run” suggests he is a man who keeps his emotions under control.

**1 mark** — Yet his **uncharacteristic speed** shows the depth of his **worry and relief**: the moment

is so important that even his usual restraint gives way. The reader senses how frightened the family has been.

**Q11.** [1] — Tone of the final sentence

**1 mark** — Any **one** of: **reflective, grateful, tender, nostalgic, quietly moved**. (Reject: **sad, triumphant** — these miss the gentle, lasting gratitude conveyed by keeping the napkin “folded very small”.)

## Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

**Q12. [2]** — “A small miracle of modern commerce”

**1 mark** — In one sense it really is **astonishing** that an item of clothing can be produced, shipped and sold so cheaply — the supply chain is a feat of efficiency.

**1 mark** — **Tone:** the phrase is **ironic** / **sarcastic:** the writer does not actually admire it but uses praise-language to set up the contrast with the hidden costs revealed in the rest of the paragraph.

**Q13. [2]** — Two pieces of evidence for the scale

**1 mark each** for any two of:

- Global clothing production has “roughly doubled since the year 2000”.
- The average garment is “now worn fewer than ten times before being thrown away”.
- Fast fashion has “transformed the way the world dresses” in just twenty years.
- It produces “enormous volumes of cheap clothing at breakneck speed”.

**Q14. [2]** — Effect of the water comparison

**1 mark** — The comparison translates an abstract figure (2,700 litres) into something the reader can **visualise** / relate to personally — the drinking water of a single human being over years.

**1 mark** — It makes the scale of the waste feel **shocking** and **concrete:** one ordinary T-shirt consumes what a person would drink over a long period of time.

**Q15. [2]** — “Paid for several times over by ecosystems that send no invoice”

**1 mark** — The **true cost** of the garment — water use, pollution, microplastics — is **not reflected in its price** and is instead absorbed by the natural world.

**1 mark** — Because nature cannot demand payment (“send no invoice”), this cost is **invisible** in the market, even though it is **real and very large**. The phrase highlights the **injustice** of a system that hides its environmental costs.

**Q16. [1]** — Why “genuinely”

**1 mark** — The word “genuinely” stresses that most clothing labelled as recycled is **not really recycled** into new fabric; only a tiny fraction (about one per cent) actually is. The word warns the reader against being misled by the **appearance** of recycling.

**Q17. [2]** — “Mountain ranges” of clothing

**1 mark** — The image conveys the **sheer scale** of the waste — heaps so large that they resemble natural geographical features visible from space.

**1 mark** — It also creates a **disturbing contrast:** clothing, normally a small, personal item, has become so abundant that it forms landscapes, which makes the problem feel grotesque and unnatural.

**Q18. [2]** — “Pushed further into the shadows”

**1 mark** — Conditions have become **less visible** / **harder to monitor**; they are hidden from inspectors, journalists and consumers.

**1 mark** — The phrase also suggests these conditions are **worse** than before — what is in shadow is usually something unsavoury or shameful that someone wishes to conceal.

**Q19. [1]** — Attitude to resale

**1 mark** — **Cautiously positive** / **qualified approval**. The writer welcomes resale as a “striking counter-trend” and acknowledges a “real environmental gain”, but the use of “small” and “for some shoppers” shows he does not see it as a complete solution. (Reject: **enthusiastic**, **dismissive**.)

**Q20. [2]** — The “rebound effect” (own words)

**1 mark** — Shoppers **buy more clothes than they otherwise would** because they feel **reassured** / **guilt-free**.

**1 mark** — They believe they can **recover part of the cost** later by reselling the clothes, so the supposed environmental benefit is **cancelled out** by increased consumption.

**Q21. [2]** — Contrast in “default settings”

**1 mark** — The writer **contrasts** the careful effort of an individual (washing in a microfibre bag, mending, buying second-hand) with the unchanged industrial defaults of **overproduction**, **underpayment** and **planned disposability**.

**1 mark** — The effect is to show that **personal virtue is dwarfed by structural design**: no matter how careful the consumer is, the system continues to do harm at a scale they cannot offset.

**Q22. [2]** — “From the wardrobe to the boardroom”

**1 mark** — The contrast pairs two physical **places** that stand for two **kinds of responsibility**: the wardrobe represents the **individual consumer**, the boardroom represents **corporate decision-makers**.

**1 mark** — **Effect**: it makes the abstract idea of “structural change” concrete and memorable, and shifts the blame from where it is usually placed (the shopper) to where the writer believes it really belongs (company executives).

**Q23. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]**

**Content points** (½ mark each; 1 mark per pair, max 6 marks). **Eight available content points**; candidates should aim for all 8.

**Harms caused by fast fashion (Paragraphs 2–4):**

- Massive water use and water pollution** — thousands of litres per garment; textile dyeing causes a fifth of industrial water pollution.
- Microplastic shedding** — synthetic clothes release plastic fibres into oceans, snow and even human blood.
- Huge waste / very low recycling** — only about one per cent is genuinely recycled; the rest is burned, dumped, or shipped overseas to accumulate (e.g. the Atacama Desert).

4. **Poor labour conditions** — low wages, excessive hours, unsafe factories, mostly affecting women; auditing remains weak after Rana Plaza.

**Measures being taken to address them (Paragraphs 5–7):**

5. **Resale platforms** (Vinted, Depop, ThredUp) extend garment life and reduce new production.
6. **Changing consumer attitudes** — buying second-hand has become socially acceptable, especially among younger shoppers.
7. **Structural / legal reform** — extended-producer-responsibility laws, binding wage and safety standards across the supply chain.
8. **Bans on the destruction of unsold stock**, like the one recently introduced in France; individuals can also **buy less, wear longer and waste less**.

**Sample full-marks summary (78 words):**

**Fast fashion causes harm by** consuming vast amounts of water, polluting rivers, and releasing microplastics that reach oceans and human bodies. Almost no clothing is truly recycled; mountains of waste are burned, buried, or dumped abroad. Workers, mostly women, endure low pay and unsafe conditions. To address this, resale platforms now extend garment life, and second-hand buying has become respectable. Governments are introducing producer-responsibility laws, supply-chain standards, and bans on destroying unsold stock, while shoppers buy less and longer.

**Length count: 78 words from “Fast” onwards.**

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —